Evaluation

The UN Peacekeeping operations received a much deserved international recognition when, in 1988, the peacekeepers were awarded the Nobel Peace Prize. However, discussed earlier, the nature of peacekeeping has changed over time, especially after the end of the Cold War. Over the years, UN peacekeeping has evolved to meet the demands of different kinds of conflicts and a changing political landscape.

Peacekeeping operations have had their own share of successes and failures. In El Salvador and Mozambique, peacekeeping ensured ways to achieve self-sustaining peace. Sierra Leone, East Timor and Liberia have been successful operations. But UN peacekeeping fared badly and failed in Somalia where peacekeepers were despatched without securing either a ceasefire or the consent of warring parties. Other stories of failures include the genocide in Rwanda in 1994 and the massacre of Srebrenica in Bosnia and Herzegovina in 1995.

Added to this, there is also a mounting expenditure for peacekeeping activities. The costs skyrocketed with the additional requirements for new and expanded missions. Further, there are allegations of sexual abuse by the UN peacekeepers and alleged corruption in procurement by the UN executives in the field and the headquarters. These failures called for introspection and reform of the peacekeeping operations.

The Brahimi Report suggested an adoption of “peacekeeping doctrine that stipulates that once deployed, the United Nations peacekeepers must be able to carry out their mandates, professionally and successfully, and be capable of defending themselves, other mission components and the mission’s mandate, with robust rules of engagement, against those who renege on their commitments to a peace accord or otherwise seek to undermine it by violence”.[26] In other words, a clear, credible and achievable mandate drawn by the Security Council is to be a vital part of this doctrine.

In 1992, Secretary-General, Boutros Boutros-Ghali, in his *An Agenda for Peace,* held out plans for preventive diplomacy,